

Data Backup & Retention Policy

1. Purpose

This policy defines Robotix Technologies' requirements for backing up business data and retaining records for appropriate periods. Adequate backups protect against data loss from hardware failure, ransomware, accidental deletion, and disasters. Retention requirements ensure that Robotix Technologies meets legal, regulatory, and contractual obligations while avoiding unnecessary long-term storage of data that should be deleted.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

All business data created, received, or processed by Robotix Technologies employees and systems.

All IT systems that store or process company data, including Microsoft 365 (Exchange Online, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams), on-premises servers, AWS cloud services, SaaS applications, and local endpoint storage.

All employees who create, store, or are responsible for company data.

All contractors who create data on Robotix Technologies systems.

3. Policy Statements

3.1 Data Storage Locations - Employee Responsibilities

3.1.1 Employees must store all business data in IT-approved, backed-up locations. The primary approved storage locations are:

Platform

Use Case

Backup Coverage

OneDrive for Business

SharePoint / Teams

Individual work files, documents

Shared team files, project collaboration

Yes - Microsoft 365 backup

Yes - Microsoft 365 backup

Exchange Online (Outlook)

Email and calendar

Yes - Microsoft 365 backup

AWS S3 (IT-managed buckets)

Application data, system data

Yes - S3 versioning + cross-region replication

RobotixDesk (ServiceNow)

ITSM records, CMDB

Yes - vendor SaaS backup

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3.1.2 Data stored exclusively on local device hard drives or desktops is not backed up by IT. Employees must ensure all business-critical files are saved to OneDrive or SharePoint. Intune and Jamf policies enforce OneDrive Known Folder Move (KFM) on Windows, which automatically syncs Desktop, Documents, and Pictures folders to OneDrive.

3.1.3 Data stored on personal devices, personal cloud storage, or unauthorized SaaS tools is not covered by any IT backup and may be permanently lost. This is also a violation of the Acceptable Use Policy (POL-001).

3.2 Backup Schedule and Recovery Objectives

Robotix Technologies maintains the following backup and recovery standards for IT-managed systems:

System

Backup Method

Backup Frequency

Retention Period

RTO Target

RPO Target

Microsoft 365 (Exchange, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams)

AWS production workloads

On-premises servers

Microsoft 365 native recycle bin + third-party M365 backup (Veeam)

AWS Backup (automated daily snapshots, EBS, RDS, S3 versioning)

Veeam Backup & Replication to on-site NAS + off-site replication

Continuous / Daily snapshot

90-day recycle bin; 1-year backup archive

4 hours

24 hours

Daily

30 days

(daily), 12 months (monthly)

4 hours

24 hours

Daily full + hourly incremental

14 days

on-site; 90 days off-site

8 hours

1 hour

RobotixDesk (SaaS)

Vendor-managed backup

Vendor SLA

Per vendor agreement

Per vendor SLA

Per vendor SLA

Endpoint (OneDrive KFM)

Microsoft 365 OneDrive versioning + M365 backup

Continuous sync

90-day version history; 1-year archive

Self-service restore; 4 hours L2 assist

Near-real-time

3.2.1 Recovery Time Objective (RTO): The maximum acceptable time to restore a system or data after a failure event. 3.2.2 Recovery Point Objective (RPO): The maximum acceptable data loss measured in time (e.g., RPO of 24 hours means at most 24 hours of data may be lost).

3.2.3 Backup integrity is verified monthly by L3 Engineering through test restores. Annual disaster recovery (DR) exercises test full system recovery and are documented in the DR report submitted to the CISO.

3.2.4 Backup failures are monitored automatically; alerts are sent to the L3 Engineering on-call queue. Failed backups must be investigated and resolved within 24 hours.

3.3 Data Retention Schedule

Data must be retained for the minimum period required by business, legal, or regulatory requirements, then disposed of securely. The following retention schedule applies:

Data Category

Retention Period

Basis

Employee email (general business)

Financial and accounting records

Client contracts and engagement records

Human resources records (personnel files)

7 years

7 years

Legal / regulatory default

IRS / SOX requirements

7 years after engagement end

Legal requirement

7 years after separation

Employment law

Payroll records

7 years

FLSA / IRS

IT security logs (firewall, Okta, CrowdStrike, VPN)

1 year active; 2 years

archived

Security operations standard

Incident and change management tickets (RobotixDesk)

5 years

IT governance

Meeting recordings (Teams / Zoom)

90 days (unless designated

for retention)

Business default

Slack messages

1 year

Business default

General business documents (non-contract)

Marketing and public communications

5 years

3 years

Business default

Business default

Regulated personal data (PII, PHI)

Per applicable regulation (HIPAA, CCPA, GDPR) + 1 year

Regulatory

Data subject to legal hold

Until hold is released

Legal requirement (see 3.4)

3.3.1 Data must not be deleted before its minimum retention period has elapsed unless a valid legal, privacy (data subject request), or business exception applies.

3.3.2 Data must not be retained beyond its retention period without a documented business justification. Retention beyond the scheduled period increases legal discovery risk and storage cost.

3.3.3 Employees with questions about the retention schedule for specific data should contact the IT Service Desk or Legal.

3.4 Legal Holds

3.4.1 A legal hold (also called a litigation hold) is an order to preserve specified data beyond its normal retention period because of pending or anticipated litigation, investigation, audit, or regulatory proceeding.

3.4.2 Legal holds are initiated by the Legal team. When a hold is issued, the Legal team will: 1. Notify the IT Security & Compliance team of the hold scope (custodians, date range, data types). 2. IT will apply a

Microsoft Purview Compliance Center hold on the affected mailboxes, OneDrive accounts, and SharePoint sites. 3. Affected employees will receive notification that their data is subject to hold (unless Legal determines notification would prejudice the matter).

3.4.3 Employees who receive a legal hold notification must not delete, modify, or move any data that may be in scope, regardless of its normal retention period. Violation of a legal hold is a serious legal infraction with potential civil and criminal consequences.

3.4.4 Employees must contact Legal immediately if they receive any subpoena, court order, or regulatory inquiry related to company data.

3.5 Secure Data Disposal

3.5.1 When data reaches the end of its retention period or must be deleted for privacy compliance (e.g., GDPR right to erasure request), it must be disposed of securely:

Data Type

Disposal Method

Microsoft 365 files / email

Deleted from SharePoint/OneDrive/Exchange; automatically purged from Microsoft's systems after recycle bin period per M365 backup retention

Local device data

Device wiped per NIST SP 800-88 per POL-010

Physical documents

AWS data

Backup media

Cross-cut shredder or locked shred bins (Iron Mountain or equivalent)

S3 lifecycle policies for deletion; RDS automated deletion; documented in Change Management

Physical destruction or cryptographic erase per NIST SP 800-88

3.5.2 Bulk data deletion requests (e.g., deleting records for a departed client) must be submitted via RobotixDesk and approved by IT Security and Legal before execution.

3.5.3 Records of data disposal (certificates of destruction for physical media, deletion logs for electronic data) must be retained for 3 years.

3.6 Employee File Recovery

3.6.1 Employees who accidentally delete files from OneDrive or SharePoint may self-restore from the recycle bin within 93 days. Instructions are available in the IT knowledge base at <https://help.robotix.com>.

3.6.2 For file recovery beyond the recycle bin period, or for email recovery beyond the "Recoverable Items" folder, employees must submit a recovery request via RobotixDesk. Recovery from backup is possible within the backup retention window per section 3.2.

3.6.3 Recovery requests are fulfilled by L2 Desktop & Systems within 2 business days for standard requests, or within 4 hours for P2-priority business-critical data loss events.

4. Roles & Responsibilities

Role

Responsibility

All Employees

IT Service Desk (L1)

Save work to approved backed-up locations; comply with retention schedules; comply with legal holds; report accidental data loss immediately

Accept and route data recovery requests; answer retention questions; escalate legal hold issues to Legal/IT Security

IT Security & Compliance

L2 Desktop & Systems

L3 Engineering

Legal

Finance

Own policy; enforce retention via Purview policies; apply and monitor legal holds; conduct annual DR exercise; oversee backup audit

Execute data recovery requests; manage OneDrive KFM; support Microsoft 365 backup restores

Maintain and monitor backup infrastructure; validate backup integrity monthly; manage AWS Backup and Veeam

Issue and manage legal holds; advise on regulatory retention requirements; respond to data subject

requests

Retain financial records per schedule; advise on statutory retention obligations

5. Enforcement & Consequences

Storing data only on local drives (not backed-up locations): Written warning; IT assistance to migrate data to OneDrive; mandatory training.

Deleting data subject to a legal hold: Immediate escalation to Legal; HR investigation; potential personal legal liability.

Unauthorized bulk deletion of records: Immediate suspension of data access; HR/Legal investigation.

Failure to complete recovery from backup within SLA: L3 Engineering incident review; escalation to CISO.

6. Exceptions

Exceptions to retention periods (shorter retention for cost or privacy reasons, or longer retention for unique business needs) require: 1. Written justification from the data owner. 2. Legal review for compliance impact. 3. IT Security approval. 4. Documentation in the IT GRC system with an annual review date.

7. Related Documents

POL-001 - Acceptable Use Policy

POL-005 - Data Classification & Handling Policy

POL-009 - Access Control & Least Privilege Policy

POL-010 - IT Asset Management Policy

REF-0001 - Robotix IT Environment Standards

Disaster Recovery Plan (restricted; L3 Engineering)

(cid:127) Microsoft 365 Backup & Recovery Guide (internal wiki)

Legal Hold Procedure (Legal team)

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8. Revision History

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Author

1.0

2.0

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IT Operations

2023-05-01

IT Security & Compliance

2.1

2024-02-15

2.2

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IT Security & Compliance

IT Security & Compliance

Robotix IT Service Desk · Synthetic knowledge base · This document is fictional sample data.

Summary of Changes

Initial backup and retention policy

Full rewrite; added Veeam M365 backup; formalized retention schedule table; added legal hold procedures

Added OneDrive KFM clause; updated AWS backup details; added Slack 1-year retention

Annual review; updated meeting recording retention to 90 days; added data disposal certificate retention requirement

Robotix Technologies — Internal IT Documentation · Synthetic data, no PII.